century, and Malayali nurses in the 20th century, migration has offered prospects of upward mobility to women, even in the most trying conditions.

Identity, Politics and Citizenship

Indians outside India often cry out about charges of discrimination, real or perceived. The racist immigration policies of the anglophone world in the early 20th century certainly set the tone in those parts of the world for the rest of the century. In West Asia today, the demands are about social justice, even as migrants accept the reality that there can never be any permanent settlement in that region. But the fault-lines of migration and identity are more clearly witnessed back home in India, in the major metropolitan cities and along national and provincial borders. The much hallowed Indian diversity is routinely tested by claims on ethnicity, region and language, pitting the insiders or 'sons of the soil' (and presumably daughters) versus the proverbial mlecchas or outsiders.

One of the earliest instances of the 'sons of the soil' movement was under the Nizam rule of Hyderabad state in the late 19th century. The state was founded by Asaf Jah in 1724 after the collapse of Mughal power. His subjects were known as the *mulki*s (the word 'mulk' meaning country).[47] Non-mulkis were referred to as the *ghair*-mulkis, and they began to enter the government services in large numbers under Salar Jung's administration in the late 19th century. Jung had inherited an administration in chaos and was trying to rope in the best talent from outside. The immigrants were Muslims from the Bombay, Madras and Bengal Presidencies and the United Provinces (Uttar Pradesh). Through their kith and kin many more arrived to serve the Hyderabad administration. The mulkis, especially the Muslim mulkis, became hostile to this influx from outside and under pressure, in 1868, Jung instituted a policy to recruit only mulkis in government administration. This laid the foundation of the principle of promoting native interests over the migrants in government employment. Further steps were taken in subsequent decades such as changing the official language of the government from Persian to Urdu, the language of local Muslims, and the